

Yan Jiang

Curriculum Vitae

Stanford Center on Early Childhood
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Department of Education Studies with a Specialization in Computational Social Science, University of California, San Diego, 2025

Dissertation: *Reimagining Conceptions of Quality in Early Care and Education in Diverse Societies: A Comparative Analysis Leveraging Computational Methods*

Committee: Amanda Datnow (co-chair), Alison Wishard Guerra (co-chair), Alan Daly, Margaret Roberts

M.A. Department of English Literature, Sichuan International Studies University, China, 2012

B.A. Department of Education, China West Normal University, China, 2009

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2025-present Postdoctoral Scholar, Stanford Center on Early Childhood, Stanford University

PUBLICATIONS

Peer Reviewed Journal Articles & Book Chapters

- In press Kim, S., Ko-Wong, L., & **Jiang, Y.** Critical race theory perspectives on bullying victimization of marginalized minorities. In M. Sapouna, R. A. Willems, & P. K. Smith (Eds.), *The Cambridge Handbook of Bias-Based Bullying*. Cambridge University Press.
- 2026 **Jiang, Y.**, Liu, S., & Fisher, P. A. (2026). *A comparative evaluation of structural topic models and BERTopic for short, open-ended survey responses*. arXiv.
<https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2605.23093>
- 2025 **Jiang, Y.**, Ko-Wong, L., & Valdovinos Gutierrez, I. The feasibility and comparability of using artificial intelligence for qualitative data analysis in equity-focused research. *Educational Researcher*, 54(3), 153-163.
<https://doi.org/10.3102/0013189X251314821>

- 2025 **Jiang, Y.**, Kaplan, B., & Ko-Wong, L. Does teacher talk matter too? A meta-analysis of partial correlations between teachers' language practices and children's language development from preschool to third grade. *Review of Educational Research*. <https://doi.org/10.3102/00346543251339131>
- 2025 Hassani, A., Flores, M., Streuli, S., **Jiang, Y.**, Wishard Guerra, A., & Fielding-Miller, R. After mandates end: Complex decision making regarding COVID masking in San Diego elementary schools through the Social Ecological Model. *Journal of School Health*. <https://doi.org/10.1111/josh.70026>
- 2024 **Jiang, Y.**, Guerra, A. W., Cohen, S. R., Brown, T. T., Lin, N. T., Molgaard, M., & Iversen, J. Echoing parental scaffolding style in co-constructed narratives: Its impact on executive function development in diverse early school-age children. *Early Education and Development*, 35(6), 1335–1352. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10409289.2024.2360872>

Under Review

- Datnow, A., **Jiang, Y.**, Diaz, J., Park, V. (revise & resubmit). Tracing shifts in K–12 education research: A topic modeling analysis of publications from 1990-2023. *Educational Researcher*.
- Jiang, Y.** (revise & resubmit). Navigating the “ideals”: A comparative case study of early educators' sensemaking of quality in the United States and China. *Teaching and Teacher Education*.
- Jiang, Y.** (revise & resubmit). The geography of knowledge: Investigating the Global imbalance in early care and education quality research. *Child Development*.
- Jiang, Y.**, Liu, S., & Fisher, P. A. (under review). A comparative evaluation of structural topic models and BERTopic for short, open-ended survey responses. *Advances in Methods and Practices in Psychological Science*.

In Preparation

- Jiang, Y.**, Liu, S., Fisher, P.A. Tracing Shifts in the Personal and Professional Challenges of 5,500 Early Care and Education Providers: A Five-Year Analysis.
- Jiang, Y.** “In this classroom, they are not poor kids”: Head Start Educators' Equity-Oriented Practices Serving Refugee Children.
- Jiang, Y.** Toward an expanded conceptual model of early care and education quality: A computational analysis of 53 years of research.

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

- 2026 Chancellor's Dissertation Medal, Honorable Mention, UC San Diego
- 2025 Yankelovich Graduate Research Grant, UC San Diego
- 2025 Summer Scholars Fellowship, Department of Education Studies, UC San Diego
- 2024 Dissertation Research Funding Award, Society for Research in Child Development
- 2024 Edward A. Bouchet Graduate Honor Society, Honorable Mention

2024	International Institute Research Fellowship, UC San Diego
2024	Summer Graduate Teaching Scholars Fellowship, UC San Diego
2024, 2025	Diversity Fellowship, Department of Education Studies, UC San Diego
2024	Graduate Student Travel Award, American Educational Research Association
2023, 2024	GSPA Travel Grant Award, UC San Diego
2023	Friends of the International Center Fellowship, UC San Diego
2023, 2025	Graduate Student Travel Award, Society for Research in Child Development
2020	Summer Research Fellowship, Department of Education Studies, UC San Diego

GRANT ACTIVITY

2026	Co-Investigator, <i>Centering Race in the Lived Experiences of a Racially Stratified Early Childhood Education Workforce: Personal and Professional Challenges, Turnover Intentions, and Pathways to Well-Being and Justice</i> . Spencer Racial Equity Research Grants. Principal Investigator: Philip Fisher; Co-Investigator: Sihong Liu. Amount requested: \$73,663. Status: Applied.
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TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of California, San Diego, Sole Instructor

Cognitive Development and Education (Summer 2025)

Early Learning Environments for Diverse Learners (Summer 2024)

University of California, San Diego, Teaching Assistant

Introduction to Research Design and Quantitative Data Analysis (Winter 2022, doctoral course)

Advanced Quantitative Data Analysis (Spring 2022, doctoral course)

Early Childhood Policy: Contexts and Policies in Diverse Societies (Fall & Winter 2021)

Early Learning Environments for Diverse Learners (Spring & Fall 2021)

Cognitive Development and Education (Fall 2019, Winter & Spring 2020)

University of California, San Diego, Guest Lecturer

Early Childhood Teacher Language Practices (February 2025)

Systematic Review: Design and Implementation (January 2025)

Conducting Systematic Reviews: Methods and Best Practices (January 2024)

Mentored Students

Lily Hofstetter, Undergraduate, Various Research Projects, Vanderbilt University (2023-2025)

Marla Carrillo and Caetano Geraci, Undergraduate, International Institute Research Summer Fellowship, UC San Diego & San Diego Mesa College (2024)

Angline Estrada, Undergraduate, Summer Research Project, UC San Diego (2023)
 Evelyn Cho, Undergraduate, Summer Research Project, UC San Diego (2022)
 Yoosang Park, Undergraduate, Various Research Projects, UC Berkeley (2021-2022)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND PANELS

Papers

- 2026 Shah, M., **Jiang, Y.**, Yang, F., Liu, S., Fisher, P.A. From Data to Lived Experience: Understanding Child Care Workforce Strain Across Settings. National Association for the Education of Young Children (NAEYC) Annual Conference, Washington, D.C. (accepted)
- 2026 **Jiang, Y.**, Liu, S., Fisher, P.A. Centering Lived Experiences in Education Data Science: A Five-Year Analysis of Early Care and Education Providers' Experiences with Challenges. Stanford Education Data Science Conference, Stanford, CA.
- 2026 **Jiang, Y.** Toward an expanded conceptual model of early care and education quality: A computational analysis of 53 years of research. American Educational Research Association Conference (AERA), Los Angeles, CA.
- 2026 Datnow, A., **Jiang, Y.**, Diaz, J., Park, V. Tracing shifts in K–12 education research: A topic modeling analysis of publications from 1990-2023. American Educational Research Association Conference (AERA), Los Angeles, CA.
- 2024 **Jiang, Y.**, Ko-Wong, L., Valdovinos, I. Can AI perform qualitative coding like human researchers? Application of GPT-3 in thematic analysis of qualitative data. American Educational Research Association Conference (AERA), Philadelphia, PA.
- 2024 **Jiang, Y.**, Ko-Wong, L., Kaplan, B. Does teacher talk matter too? A meta-analysis of partial correlations between teachers' language practices and children's language development from preschool to third grade. American Educational Research Association Conference (AERA), Philadelphia, PA.
- 2024 **Jiang, Y.**, Ko-Wong, L., Kaplan, B. Reevaluating research paradigms for early-childhood teacher language practices in global contexts: evidence from a meta-analysis and a call to the field. Comparative and International Education Society Conference (CIES), Miami, FL.
- 2024 Becerra Songolo, R., Wishard Guerra, A., Cohen S. R., Molgaard, M., **Jiang, Y.**, Li, H. Parental cognitive stimulation during an exploratory task: Understanding guided play through a sociocultural lens. American Educational Research Association Conference (AERA), Philadelphia, PA.
- 2023 **Jiang, Y.**, Guerra, A. W., Cohen S. R., Molgaard, M., Lin, N. Connecting home to school: Parents' use of evaluative devices and transitional-kindergarteners' social-emotional competence at school. American Educational Research Association Conference (AERA), Chicago, IL.

- 2023 **Jiang, Y.**, Guerra, A. W., Cohen S. R., Molgaard, M., Lin, N., Songolo, R., Li, H. Does child vocabulary mediate the relationship between parental sensitivity and child executive function? A mixed picture. Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD) Biennial Conference, Salt Lake City, UT.
- 2023 Molgaard, M., Wishard Guerra, A., Cohen S. R., **Jiang, Y.**, Lin, N. Colorblind or color-conscious: Parent responses to young children's inquiries of racial injustice. Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD) Biennial Conference, Salt Lake City, UT.
- 2022 Wishard Guerra, A., Cohen S. R., Molgaard, M., Lin, N., **Jiang, Y.** Understanding classroom language practices over time among socioculturally diverse young children in transitional kindergarten. American Educational Research Association Conference (AERA), San Diego, CA.

Posters

- 2026 **Jiang, Y.** The Geography of Knowledge: Investigating the global imbalance in early childhood education quality research. International Conference on the Science of Science and Innovation (ICSSI), Boulder, CO.
- 2025 **Jiang, Y.**, Carrillo, M., Hofstetter, L., Geraci, C. Mapping 53 years of research on early childhood education quality: A topic model analysis from 1970-2023. Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD) Biennial Conference, Minneapolis, MN.
- 2024 **Jiang, Y.**, Hogan, W., Diaz, J., Kennedy, B. C., Hofstetter, L. A Comparative NLP analysis of policymakers' and practitioners' perceptions of quality in California's universal prekindergarten initiative. 10th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC²S²), Philadelphia, PA.
- 2024 **Jiang, Y.**, Ko-Wong, L., Kaplan, B. Does teachers' Instructional Support measured by CLASS associated with children's language development? Evidence from a meta-analysis. National Research Conference on Early Childhood (NRCEC), Washington, D.C.
- 2024 **Jiang, Y.**, Hofstetter, L., Diaz, J., Kennedy, B. C., Hogan, W. A comparative analysis of diverse stakeholders' perceptions of "quality" in California's universal prekindergarten initiative using text as data. National Research Conference on Early Childhood (NRCEC), Washington, D.C.
- 2024 Becerra Songolo, R., Wishard Guerra, A., Cohen S. R., Molgaard, M., **Jiang, Y.**, Li, H. Parent-child play interactions & their significance for educators' engagement with parents. International Congress for School Effectiveness and Improvement Conference (ICSEI), Dublin, Ireland.
- 2023 **Jiang, Y.**, Guerra, A. W., Cohen S. R., Molgaard, M., Lin, N. Parent-child language quality in three play activities and its relation to children's language development. Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD) Biennial Conference, Salt Lake City, UT.

- 2023 Li, H., Wishard Guerra, A., Cohen S. R., Molgaard, M., **Jiang, Y.**, Songolo, R. The association of parent mental health and use of negative discipline strategies. Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD) Biennial Conference, Salt Lake City, UT.
- 2022 **Jiang, Y.**, Guerra, A. W., Cohen S. R., Molgaard, M., Park, Y. Parent-child language quantity and complexity during play and its relation to children's language development. Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD) Featured Conference, St. Louis, MO.
- 2021 **Jiang, Y.**, Jackson, C., Wishard-Guerra, A. W., Cohen S. R. Co-constructed narratives: Association between parent reminiscing style and children's self-regulation. Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD) Biennial Conference (Virtual).
- 2021 Jackson, C., **Jiang, Y.**, Wishard Guerra, A., Cohen S. R. Parent scaffolding and child contribution in a co-constructed narrative. Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD) Biennial Conference (Virtual).

Panels Invited

- 2026 Navigating the PhD and unpacking the hidden curriculum, Graduate Student Council Division E Fireside Chat, American Educational Research Association Conference (AERA), Los Angeles, CA. (scheduled)
- 2024 Strategies for sustaining motivation throughout your PhD journey, Comparative and International Education Society Conference, Miami, FL.

Panels Organized

- 2025 Navigating your PhD program — Strategies for success at every stage, w/ Yi-Yun Tsai, Graduate Student Council Division E Fireside Chat, American Educational Research Association Conference (AERA), Denver, CO.
- 2024 Navigating the job market — A guide for graduate students, w/ Allison Fears, Graduate Student Council Division E Fireside Chat, American Educational Research Association Conference (AERA), Philadelphia, PA.

Sessions Chaired

- 2026 Toward a transnational educational research agenda, American Educational Research Association Conference (AERA), Los Angeles, CA. (scheduled)
- 2026 Exploring the intersections of artificial intelligence and educational research, American Educational Research Association Conference (AERA), Los Angeles, CA. (scheduled)

INVITED TALKS AND PANELS

- 2025 Approaching and Writing Your Dissertation, Online Seminar, Towards 2044: Horowitz Early Career Scholar Program, Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), Dec 16.

- 2025 The Postdoc Pathway: Navigating Postdoctoral Positions and Life from PhD to Postdoc, Online Webinar, Education Major PhD Student Community, Nov 21.
- 2023 Teachers' language practices and young children's language development, San Diego Vista Unified School District, May 7.

MEDIA APPEARANCES

- 2026 Teacher Talk and Language Development: What Do You Think the Evidence Shows, Podcast Session ([Spotify](#), [YouTube](#)), The Literacy View.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2025 **Postdoctoral Scholar** with Dr. Philip Fisher
Stanford Center on Early Childhood, Stanford University
Conduct secondary data analyses using existing national datasets from the RAPID survey project and the Childcare Development Fund (CCDF) to understand how families' and educators' experiences related to early care and education access have been shifting, and how state-level child care assistance policies affected their experiences.
- 2022-2025 **Graduate Student Researcher** with Dr. Monica Sweet
Center for Research on Educational Equity, Assessment & Teaching Excellence, UC San Diego
Conducted analysis of state-level survey data for Computer Science Professional Development Week for Computer Science Teachers Association. Developed practitioner-oriented evaluation reports to inform program improvements.
- 2024-2025 **Graduate Student Researcher** with Dr. Amy Bintliff
International Research Partnership: Wellbeing Club for Refugee Youth in Uganda, UC San Diego
Served as quantitative data analysis consultant. Interpreted and visualized data for practitioner audiences and supported the development of peer-reviewed manuscripts.
- 2022-2023 **Graduate Student Researcher** with Dr. Rebecca Fielding-Miller & Dr. Alison Wishard Guerra
The Safer at School Early Alert Project, UC San Diego
Analyzed qualitative interview data on parent and child beliefs about COVID-19 and mask-wearing. Contributed to coding, thematic analysis, and interpretation of findings.
- 2020-2022 **Graduate Student Researcher** with Dr. Alison Wishard Guerra & Dr. Shana R. Cohen
Research Practice Partnership (RPP) New Vistas Research Project, UC San Diego
Analyzed audio and video data of home visits and parent-child interactions. Presented findings at academic conferences and led the writing of manuscripts for publication.

2020-2022 **Graduate Student Researcher** with Dr. Alison Wishard Guerra & Dr. Shana R. Cohen
University of California, Office of The President (UCOP), University of California
Supported the development of a cross-campus online course. Built course infrastructure in Canvas and designed innovative assessments, including interactive video quizzes.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Journal and Conference Peer Reviewer

Education Studies, 2026

Review of Educational Research, 2026

Child Development, 2026

Early Childhood Research Quarterly, 2025

The Elementary School Journal, 2025

Journal of Transformative Education, 2025

American Educational Research Association Annual Conferences, 2022-2025

Comparative and International Education Society Conferences, 2023-2024

International Conference on Computational Social Science, 2024-2026

National Research Conference on Early Childhood, 2024-2025

Society for Research in Child Development Biennial Conference (mentee reviewer), 2022

Early Childhood Research Quarterly (ad hoc with advisor), 2022

Service to the Field

Human Development Section Meeting Leader, Division E: Counseling and Human Development, American Educational Research Association, 2026-2027

- Led planning for a member-centered section meeting to gather Human Development members' perspectives and inform Division E initiatives

Elected Student & Early Career Council Representative to the Development Committee, Society for Research in Child Development, 2025-2029

- Reviewer, SRCD SECC Dissertation Research Funding Awards, 2025-2026

Graduate Student Representative, Graduate Student Council, American Educational Research Association, 2023-2025

- Co-Chair, Graduate Students Professional Development On-line Webinar: How to AERA — Denver (March 2025)
- Chair, Graduate Students Professional Development On-line Webinar: Grant Writing and Funding Opportunities (February 2025)

- Co-Chair, Graduate Students Professional Development On-line Webinar: Demystifying the Academic Job Market (January 2025)

Graduate Student Representative, Early Education & Child Development SIG, American Educational Research Association, 2024-2025

Finance co-chair, New Scholars Committee, Comparative and International Education Society, 2023-2024

University Service

Mentor, Graduate Pals for Graduate Students, UC San Diego, 2023-2024

Graduate student board member, Academic Integrity Review Board, UC San Diego, 2022-2023

Students with Dependents Committee, Graduate & Professional Student Association, UC San Diego, 2022-2023

Selected Community Service

Urban Village Early Learning Academy (Head Start), 2025-2025

Fay Elementary School, Fall 2022

Early Childhood Education Center, Winter 2020

Save the Children & Inno Community Development Organization, China, 2020

Benchu Bilingual Family Child Care, China, 2019

Chengdu Thermal Power Plant Kindergarten, 2018

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

2025	Write to Change the World and Connection Workshop AERA Division E & OpEd Project, 1-day on-line workshop Selected from a pool of applicants
2024	Improving Evaluations of R&D in STEM Education Northwestern University, Evanston, IL, 1-week in-person workshop Selected from a pool of applicants Instructors: Larry Hedges, Eric Hedberg
2024	Summer Graduate Teaching Scholars Program UC San Diego, San Diego, CA, summer teaching workshops Selected from a pool of applicants
2022	Systematic Review & Meta Analysis University of Maryland, 1-week on-line workshop Instructors: Joshua Polanin
2022	Structural Equation Modeling University of Maryland, 1-week on-line workshop Instructors: Gregory Hancock

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

American Educational Research Association, 2020-Present

Society for Research in Child Development, 2020-Present

Comparative and International Education Society, 2023-Present

Reconceptualizing Early Childhood Education, 2024-Present

International Society for Computational Social Science, 2024-Present

Sigma Xi - The Scientific Research Honor Society, 2026-Present

PROGRAM LANGUAGES

R, Python, SPSS, Stata

LANGUAGES

English & Mandarin: Advanced reading, writing, speaking